

MODULE 3 - MEMORY

Save or Not - Decision Tree

When something interesting happens, what goes into the brain and what doesn't.

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Author: Chase Whited / Whited Consulting

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Save or Not - The Decision Tree

When something interesting happens in a session, you face a fast decision: save it to the brain, or let it go. Saving everything bloats the brain; saving nothing means re-deriving context next session. Use this tree.

Step 1 - Will I want this in three months?

If the answer is no, do not save it. Skip the rest of the tree. Daily activity that is already covered by a Daily Log entry does not need a separate memory entry.

If yes, continue.

Step 2 - Is it a fact or an action?

Facts persist - they go into memory. Actions are events - they go into Daily Log or Change Log.

- Action: a commit, a deploy, a customer call, a bug fix. -> Daily Log + Change Log.
- Fact: a standing rule, a preference, a positioning lock, a scope decision. -> Memory.

Step 3 - If it is a fact, which file?

Fact type	File
About me, my team, my business identity, my schedule	memory-types/user.md
A correction I made to an agent that I do not want to repeat	memory-types/feedback.md
A scope decision specific to one project	memory-types/project.md
An external authoritative source agents should cite	memory-types/reference.md
Cross-cutting fact that does not fit one of the above	MEMORY.md

Step 4 - If it is an action, which log?

Action type	File
Anything that happened today, in plain English	Daily_Log.md (always)
A commit or deploy with a SHA	Change_Log.md (also)
A decision with rationale and alternatives	Decision_Log.md (also)
A feature shipped, moved status, or was deprecated	Feature_Inventory.md (also)

Step 5 - Sanity checks before submit

- Date is in YYYY-MM-DD format.
- Headline is one short, declarative line.
- Body is 2-5 sentences. If longer, you are writing a doc, not a memory.
- No secrets, API keys, or client names not green-lit for public mention.
- If the entry supersedes an older one, you said so explicitly.

Edge cases worth naming

- **The same fact in two memory files.** Pick one home. The most specific file wins. user.md trumps MEMORY.md. project.md trumps user.md when the fact is project-scoped.
- **A correction that became a standing rule.** Start in feedback.md. After three repeats promote to MEMORY.md or to a CLAUDE.md section.
- **A reference that became a decision.** Promote it. The original reference.md entry stays; a new Decision_Log entry references back to it.